

01

CONTEMPORARY INDIA ANCHOR — PLURALISM AS INTERFAITH PRACTICE [SUPPORTING]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Contemporary India anchor — pluralism as interfaith practice [SUPPORTING]: □□ Inference: Public praise of interfaith harmony supports pluralism as an ethic of engagement, but it does not establish Hick's metaphysical claim that rival religions are equally valid responses to one Real.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The philosophical question of truth remains separate from the political value of coexistence.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Inference: Public praise of interfaith harmony supports pluralism as an ethic of engagement, but it does not establish Hick's metaphysical claim that rival religions are equally valid responses to one Real.

ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: In April 2026, the United Nations in India reported that UNAOC High Representative Miguel Ángel Moratinos highlighted India's historical religious pluralism and interfaith traditions during a Delhi visit.

02

VISUAL GATEWAY — FOUR QUESTIONS, NOT ONE

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Visual gateway — four questions, not one: Master verdict: Pluralism is strongest when it combines realism about an Absolute with fallibilism about finite access, while openly admitting that some first-order truth-claims remain contradictory.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Inclusivism: one's own religion is the fullest truth, but other religions contain partial truth and their adherents may be saved through it (Karl Rahner's "anonymous Christians").

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The worry (2022): "unquestionable acceptance of only one Absolute Truth will inevitably result in religious exclusivism" → and exclusivism breeds conflict/intolerance. □

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

258), whose own wording in Epistle 73 is *salus extra ecclesiam non est* — "there is no salvation outside the Church"; he also writes that one cannot have God as Father who does not have the Church as mother (*De Ecclesiae Catholicae Unitate* 6).

ANSWER LINE: Vedāntic pluralism distinguishes one ultimate reality from diverse conceptual and devotional approaches, but unity must not erase genuine doctrinal contradiction.